

Decision letter (Initial Submission)

Testing the wind disruption and disturbance refugia hypothesis for mountain pine beetle outbreaks (*Dendroctonus ponderosae*)

Subject Agricultural and Forest Entomology - Decision on Manuscript ID AFE(2026)5804

Date sent 22 September 2026 at 07:25 GMT-7

From afe_office@wiley.com

To seamusrobertmurphy@gmail.com

CC seamusrobertmurphy@gmail.com, Christian.MacQuarrie@nrcan-rncan.gc.ca

Re: AFE(2026)5804 entitled "Testing the wind disruption and disturbance refugia hypothesis for mountain pine beetle outbreaks (*Dendroctonus ponderosae*)" by Murphy, Seamus Dear Dr. Murphy, Manuscript ID AFE(2026)5804 titled "Testing the wind disruption and disturbance refugia hypothesis for mountain pine beetle outbreaks (*Dendroctonus ponderosae*)", which you submitted to Agricultural and Forest Entomology, has been reviewed. I agree with the Associate Editor that the manuscript is within the scope of AFE, but the Introduction and Discussion need to be thoroughly revised to include existing literature. In addition, the novelty of the study needs to be explicitly stated since numerous modelling papers are submitted to AFE and we have limited room. Following the advice of the Associate Editor and because I think the topic of your paper is an important one, I am prepared to consider a resubmission as a new manuscript. When you resubmit, please address the Associate Editor's comments and write to me explaining what you have done. Our journal is currently transitioning to Wiley's Research Exchange submission portal. Please read these instructions carefully. If you submitted your manuscript through our Research Exchange site, you will see a link below to submit your revised manuscript: <https://submission.wiley.com/submissionBoard/1/aede2cc9-345a-4d77-8d67-a6c54ef9d5ae/current> (If no link appears, follow the instructions in the next paragraph.) Click on the link or go to submission.wiley.com/journal/AFE. Sort by journal and submission status to locate this manuscript, then click the "Revise submission" button to submit your revision. You will be able to respond to the reviewer comments when asked to "Upload your Author Response". All

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Comments to the Author: I am of the opinion that the scientific component of the manuscript is sufficiently explained and presented such that it is acceptable to be sent for peer review by AFE. I am, however, concerned that the arguments in the introduction and discussion are not well supported or linked to the (admittedly vast) literature on MPB. I have some familiarity with this system and I feel that this would be a significant impediment for most reviewers familiar with this system. For that reason I am recommending that the Editors return the manuscript to the author with an invitation to resubmit following revision. I would encourage the author to pay particular attention to developing the argument in the discussion. My initial impression is that the Discussion reiterates what has already been stated in the results. Their revised discussion should link the author's findings to the biology, ecology or management of the MPB system. I look forward to reading the author's revised manuscript. [email ref: DL-SW-4-a]

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